

to have some kind of activity going. Although the basement dwelling vampires we spoke of earlier may seem like loners, they are very likely active in multiple online communities, and playing multiplayer games. While we know Gangsta Granny is a rare exception, and we cannot expect everyone's grandparents to be always ready to jump into a game of Call of Duty, there are some applications that are incredibly accessible for people of all ages.

One of these is the mobile version of UNO. The party mode allows up to eight players to join. The software approximates real world playing very nicely, with the play pile being in a state of disorder, instead of a neat stack of cards. The approach also means that people are not handling the cards, and not passing on any disease causing germs even if they are in the same house. If people are in different cities or continents, upto four can play in a single room. It is still possible to get eight players together, by using GPS spoofing apps on Android phones, which most people who played Pokemon Go will be familiar with. Software such as iSpoofer or Dr Fone can be used by iPhone users to spoof GPS location without jailbreaking. The phone only needs to be connected to a computer running the software. The fake geoloca-

tion can be useful for a number of other purposes during lockdown.

Psych! is another accessible app that works great, but has picked up a lot of one star ratings on the app stores because of server issues after mid March. The app starts acting up during the nights here. Another great app is Spaceteam, but that requires everyone to have some kind of a voice or video conference call going on in the background through another app, preferably another device since you will be doing all kinds of things with the smartphone, including

swiping and shaking. Instead of joining through WiFi or Bluetooth, join through the internet and use a room code.

Now, there are a number of sites that allow for collaborative playing of board games too. While Tabletopia has stopped taking new subscriptions after the outbreak, Boardgamearena still is allowing people to sign up for the free tier. However, during times of heavy load, only the paid subscribers are allowed to play. Popular board games such as Carcassonne, Coup and 7 Kingdoms are available on Boardgamearena. Board-

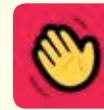
APPS FOR STAYING IN TOUCH WITH FRIENDS



Discord: This is the best option for having voice calls in the background, while using other apps or a PC. The app also supports bots that can be used to play a number of games including Dungeons & Dragons, Uno and poker.



Zoom: Multiple people can join in on a voice chat, and it supports horizontal mode unlike Duo. The free version allows for 40 minutes of conferencing, after which you can restart the call.



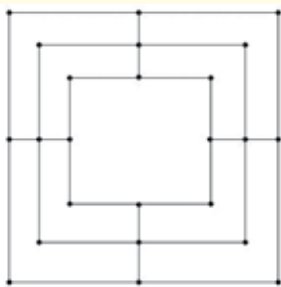
Houseparty: You simply add friends, and join your friends at their virtual "houses". Beware though, anyone on your friend list can just jump in, unless you lock the room. The app supports games such as HeadsUp and Pictionary.



Hangouts: This one is actually easy to setup and lets multiple people join in together. A link to every video chat can be shared so that people can get on at a particular time.

TRADITIONAL INDIAN GAMES

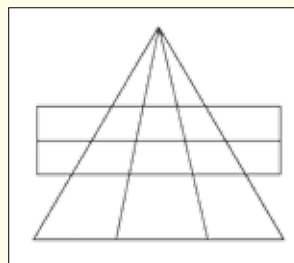
These are simply games that can be played by drawing a grid on any surface, a white board or chart paper, slate or even with a permanent marker on a blank handkerchief. Then you need two types of tokens, which can be white stones, black stones, bits of coloured chalk, tamarind seeds, rosary peas, dried beans or almost any kind of seeds. They don't even consume bandwidth, and can provide hours of play for two people.



DAHDI

Also known as Nine Men's morris, each person starts with nine pieces. The game involves placing two coloured pieces alternatively on one of the marked dots on the grid. If a player gets three pieces in a row or column, known as a "dahdi" or a "mill", they can remove a single piece of the opponent. After all the pieces are placed, players can move their pieces along the lines to an adjacent dot. A power move is to alternate a

piece between two mills, but the same mill cannot be formed more than 3 times. That means the pieces cannot be in a row or column in the same locations for removing more than three pieces during a single game. The game ends when a player is left with only 2 pieces.



WAGH BAKRI

Also called Lambs and Tigers, one player plays on the side of the 3 tigers, while the other player plays on the side of the 15 goats. Player 1 places a tiger at the top of the triangle, and Player 2 can place the goats

anywhere on the grid. Player then places all the three tigers, while Player 2 has to keep placing the goats till all the 15 goats are placed. After all their pieces are placed, the players can move their tigers or goats to an adjacent vacant intersection. While the tiger can jump over a goat to kill it and remove it from the board, the goats have to block the three tigers from making any move.